

The Fox Plan

0 to 100K Followers + \$100K Product Revenue

YouTube + TikTok. Face-to-camera. Building in public.

Written July 10, 2026, from the Zero-to-1M research report, the TikTok and YouTube mastery guides, and the 30-day acquisition plan. This is the master plan. Those docs are the reference manuals.

The Goal, Stated Honestly

Two engines, one machine:

- **Engine 1 (short game): customers.** Views convert to signups when the right person sees a demo. This starts paying in month one.
- **Engine 2 (long game): followers.** Views convert to followers at only 0.1 to 2 percent. 100K followers is a 12 to 24 month outcome for consistent founder accounts. Most people quit at month 7 with 800 followers. You won't, because Engine 1 pays you while Engine 2 compounds.

The revenue target: \$100K from BrandGoblin means reaching roughly **\$8,400 in monthly revenue** (a \$100K per year run rate). The model to copy is Marc Lou: 100K YouTube subs in 10 months, about 30 face-to-camera videos, under 10 hours a week, \$100K+ in traceable product revenue. Founder-led, low volume, high relevance.

Your identity setup (decided July 10, locked): The channels are **Fox's, permanently.** Founder-named, founder-focused. Products will evolve, BrandGoblin may change, Nix may change, but Fox is always Fox. The channel is the heart and soul of whatever you build next, so it never needs a rebrand. Display name for now: "Fox | BrandGoblin AI" (the part after the | is a swappable product tag). **Nix is the co-star**, the Duolingo-style comedy release valve, never the channel owner. A quiet **@brandgoblinai** account exists as the product home base and reposts your winners. Fresh accounts unless your Foxximuss accounts are dormant: old unrelated content poisons the algorithm's read on you, and in 2026 TikTok tests new videos on your existing followers first.

STEP 1: Setup Week (Days 1-7, before you post anything)

Days 1-2: Create the accounts

1. **TikTok:** Personal account, NOT Business (Business accounts lose trending sounds, which measurably kills reach). Same Fox handle on every platform. Bio, one line: "Building an AI that brands your idea in 2 minutes. Live, in public."
2. **YouTube:** same handle, phone-verify day one (unlocks custom thumbnails). Banner: "Watch me build BrandGoblin AI from zero." First link in channel customization = brandgoblinai.com/?ref=yt (that becomes the clickable banner link).
3. **Instagram:** same handle, same bio. Reels get the TikTok cross-posts, cheap extra lottery tickets.
4. Register **@brandgoblinai** on all three too. Park it. Post nothing yet.

Days 3-4: Prep the raw material

5. Generate 4-5 brand kits in the app and screen-record every one, full flow, sentence to finished kit. This is your demo footage library.
6. Set up the filming spot: phone at eye level, face the window, tight framing. Raw is the aesthetic. Do not buy gear.

Days 5-7: Warm up and study

7. Spend 20 minutes a day scrolling TikTok and Shorts in your niche (AI tools, branding, small business). Save every video that hooks you. This trains the algorithm on your neighborhood and trains you on hooks.
8. Write your first 6 scripts using the four formats below. Three are already written and waiting in [FIRST_3_SCRIPTS_READY_TO_FILM.pdf](#).

STEP 2: The Four Formats (your entire content menu)

Every video for the next six months is one of these. No exceptions. Formats are how viewers learn what following you gets them.

Format 1: The Live Demo (the Submagic play). 2-3 per week.

One sentence goes in, a whole brand comes out, in real time. The killer framing is comparison: "An agency charges \$10K for this. Watch 2 minutes." Submagic's free-vs-paid comparison format pulled 10M+ views, one video hit 18M. Comparisons survive because they are a story structure, not a trend.

Format 2: The Build-in-Public Diary (the Marc Lou play). 2 per week.

Face-to-camera, raw: "Day 12 of building an AI company solo." Real numbers, real decisions, real failures. Revenue screenshots when they exist. This converts viewers into fans and fans into customers. The day counter is an open story loop: following you is the only way to see how it ends.

Format 3: The Hot Take / Reaction (the Kallaway play). 1-2 per week.

Sharp takes on famous rebrands, terrible logos, AI design news. Reaches the broad creative audience beyond your niche. Rule: when branding or AI news breaks, ship a take within 24 hours. Every fast-growth story in the research was someone posting daily when a wave hit.

Format 4: The Nix Bit (the Duolingo play). 1 per week, max.

Nix as recurring co-star with one consistent personality. He creates the shareable moments; your face builds the trust that sells software. Never let the goblin become the channel.

The hook rules (non-negotiable, hooks are 80% of the game): Viewers decide in 2-3 seconds. Hook = visual + spoken + on-screen text, all three, in the first 2 seconds. Captions on everything (60%+ watch muted). Length: 20-40 seconds for TikTok and Shorts, 8-15 minutes for YouTube long-form. Hook patterns that fit you: outcome-first ("I built this entire brand from one sentence"), enemy-first ("Agencies charge \$10K for what took 2 minutes"), stakes-first ("Day 12. If this flops I'm done"), curiosity ("The goblin named my company better than I did").

PHASE 1: 0 to 1,000 followers (months 1-4)

Goal: find the 2-3 formats that reliably hold viewers past 3 seconds. Nothing else matters yet.

- **Cadence:** 5-7 TikToks a week, cross-posted natively to Shorts and Reels (never with a watermark: watermarked reposts carry a documented ~25x view penalty on YouTube). One long-form YouTube video every 2 weeks.
- **Workload:** 8-12 hours a week. Batch-film on 2 fixed days, 5-7 videos per session.
- **Run the 30-day acquisition plan inside this phase.** Demo videos do double duty: content for the algorithm, ammo for Reddit and community seeding. First posts Day 4, Spark Ads decision Day 18, only on a video that already won organically.
- **Expect silence.** Weeks of near-zero views is NORMAL. Submagic's 10 quiet days was the lucky version; 30-100 posts before a breakout is typical. 50-500 views per video in month one means the machine is calibrating, not broken.
- **After 30 posts, run kill/keep/boost:** kill the format with consistently bottom-tier completion rates, keep the top two, make more small variations of your single best video. Never judge a format on fewer than 10 attempts.

Phase 1 revenue moves

- Every video CTA: "search BrandGoblin AI" spoken out loud, plus link in TikTok bio and YouTube channel page.
- Put your first paying customers in a WhatsApp or Discord group ("BrandGoblin Founders"). Submagic did this with their first 100 and word of mouth became their top channel.
- **Milestone: first \$500 month.** Achievable from the acquisition plan alone.

PHASE 2: 1,000 to 10,000 followers (months 3-9)

Goal: turn views into follows with SERIES, and views into signups with a repeatable CTA.

Warning: this is the burnout valley. Creator burnout peaks at 5-10K. Systemize or die.

- **Cadence:** hold 5-7 shorts a week. Long-form goes weekly if sustainable. Cut every long-form into 3-4 Shorts (the hybrid strategy that grows subscribers up to 3x faster).
- **Name your series.** "One Sentence, One Brand" Ep. 12. Same intro line every episode. Series are the follow-converter; one-off videos just rent views. This is the single biggest lever for the follower goal.
- **Open a public story loop:** "Building to 1,000 users. Day 41." The counter only resolves if they follow.
- **Reply to every comment in the first hour after posting.** TikTok 2026 tests videos on your followers first, so early engagement from your base is disproportionately valuable.
- **Kill/keep/boost:** kill video types that get views but zero profile visits. Boost whatever drives signups even at modest views. Watch saves and shares, not likes. A save means "I'll use this later," the closest signal to purchase intent.

Phase 2 revenue moves

- Feature community members' brands in videos. Every featured user shares the video. Content, feedback, and word of mouth in one move.
- Collect testimonials and user brand reveals as a content format.
- **Milestone: \$2,000/month.** If followers grow but signups don't, the audience is misaligned. Fix targeting before scaling volume.

PHASE 3: 10,000 to 100,000 followers (months 9-24)

Goal: scale distribution without scaling your hours. The 50K-100K wall is where solo creators break. Buy help before you hit it.

- **Hire a part-time editor.** The single documented fix for the solo ceiling. You film, they cut. Keep the raw feel; outsource everything after the record button. Budget from product revenue.
- **Launch the affiliate program. This is the big one.** Submagic's real engine was never their own account: it was 50-70 small creators (eventually 10,000+) posting daily at 30% lifetime commission, driving about \$1.6M of revenue. BrandGoblin's users are literally people starting brands, many of them creators. Same flywheel: (1) 30% recurring commission, (2) a starter kit teaching affiliates the exact formats that already worked on YOUR account, (3) recruit from your own community first, using your own numbers as the pitch.
- **Spin up @brandgoblinai for real** (the Cal AI play): pure demos, user brand reveals, affiliate-style clips. More accounts = more lottery tickets. Your personal account stays founder-led.
- **Keep the 24-hour wave rule.** Every fast climber was already posting daily when their wave broke. You can't schedule the wave. You can be ready.
- **Kill/keep/boost:** if TikTok stalls but YouTube compounds (or the reverse), rebalance hours toward the compounding platform. Don't remake last year's viral video for an audience that moved on.

Phase 3 revenue moves

- Affiliates + your content + word of mouth stacking. **Milestone: \$8,400/month = the \$100K run rate.** Working math: at a blended ~\$20/month per customer that's ~420 paying customers, minus churn, plus refill packs on top.
- Submagic's view-to-customer rate was 0.04-0.05%: roughly 100K well-targeted views per 40-50 customers. That's the honest scale of it, and why the affiliate army matters more than any single viral hit.
- **At 100K followers, run the decision gate:** if content-attributed revenue is a major channel, keep investing toward 1M. If not, fix the funnel before feeding it.

The Weekly Operating System (print this)

Day	What happens	Time
Monday	Batch film 1: 3-4 shorts (2 demos, 1-2 diary)	2 hrs
Tuesday	Edit + caption + schedule. Reply to comments	2 hrs
Wednesday	Post. First-hour replies. Study 3 outlier videos in the niche	1.5 hrs
Thursday	Batch film 2: 3 shorts + long-form segment	2 hrs
Friday	Edit + cross-post natively. Feature a community user	2 hrs
Sat/Sun	Post + replies only. If news broke, film the 24-hour take	1 hr

Total: 10-12 hours a week. If a week creeps past 15 hours, cut volume before quality. The account that wins is the one still posting in month 18.

The Scoreboard (check monthly, not daily)

Month	Followers (combined, realistic)	Revenue / month
1	0 - 300	first dollars
3	500 - 2K	\$500
6	2K - 8K	\$1,500 - 2,500
9	5K - 20K	\$3,000 - 4,000
12	10K - 40K	\$4,000 - 6,000
18	30K - 80K	\$6,000 - 8,000
24	60K - 150K	\$8,400+ = \$100K run rate

These ranges assume consistency and include the flat months. A single viral video can jump you a whole row. Seven flat weeks in a row does not mean it's broken. Judge formats after 10 attempts, judge the plan after 6 months, judge nothing after a bad Tuesday.

The Three Rules That Survive Everything

- 1. Volume buys lottery tickets, formats cash them, the product converts them.** Never optimize one and neglect the other two.
- 2. Never chase followers whose interests don't match the product.** In 2026 mismatched followers actively suppress your TikTok reach. A funny-goblin-only audience is an anchor, not an asset.
- 3. Design for month 18.** Batch filming, ruthless format reuse, help hired early. The plan only fails if you stop.

Reference manuals: ZERO_TO_1M_FOLLOWERS_PLAYBOOK_2026.md (the research behind every claim),
TIKTOK_MASTERY_FROM_SCRATCH_2026.md, YOUTUBE_MASTERY_FROM_SCRATCH_2026.md,
CUSTOMER_ACQUISITION_PLAN_100_USERS_30_DAYS.md (runs inside Phase 1),
FIRST_3_SCRIPTS_READY_TO_FILM.pdf (film these first).